

WMC Story Script (English Translation)

Prologue

Scene 0-1: [Overview of All Regions]

(BGM: Epic & Oppressive)

Narrator:

AD 2027. After a long slumber, the world was no longer the one it used to be. When the definer of time returned to the world itself, all things germinated upon time along with variables in an instant, severing the strings of harmony.

The collapse happened in a heartbeat. The six major regions that maintained the world's structure—the six regions that defined existence—sank into chaos one by one, losing contact with 7sref. Observer Liz stood before the observation platform amidst the ruins. She poured nearly all her magic into the process of chaos just to maintain this single remaining, breathing 7sref node.

And now, only two remain here. —

History has erased the traces of years, leaving only these two. The last two rookie observers of 7sref are the heirs appointed by the world. They have no choice but to embark on this journey of no return.

Whether it is fear or the unknown, choice or hesitation, the two know deeply: to mend the link of the entire civilization and let the seeds of fire spread across the world again, they must take over the responsibility bestowed by the world. Thus, the saviors named Kurosawa and Sparklink begin to write a new chapter of civilization.

Scene 0-2: [7sref · Before the Gate]

(BGM: Relaxed Electronic)

Sparklink is leaning over the console, debugging equipment. Her light blue ponytail tips rest lazily on the metal table beside her, catching the first ray of sunlight from a post-apocalyptic morning, emitting a faint pink glow that warms a corner beneath the doorway.

Sparklink: "Hey, hey, hey, come look at this. Is this reading off the charts again? Sigh, seriously, why does something big always happen whenever it's our shift?"

Kurosawa stands before the Light Gate. Her dark clothes bury the sunlight outside the door.

Under the brim of her slightly old hat, the dappled light is shattered, floating in her dark gray hair, fading into her silent and reserved stillness.

Kurosawa: "Six regions losing contact simultaneously... it was never normal to begin with."

Narrator:

"Two of them. One codenamed Kurosawa, formerly responsible for acting as the observer of the Dragon Region—a girl of few words. The other codenamed Sparklink, formerly responsible for acting as the observer of the Metropolis Region; her modified body grants her the ability to use 7sref's cutting-edge technological equipment. However, both lack experience in observation. For the mission of saving the world, they still have a long way to go."

Sparklink: "That's true, but who has seen this before? Throwing us into something this huge right away... this isn't a newbie tutorial; it's a 'hell mode' opening, isn't it?"

Kurosawa gently closed the door behind her without looking back.

Chapter 1: Sky Street Area — The Cycle Pursuing Perfection

Scene 1-1: [7sref · Before the Gate]

(BGM: Relaxed Electronic)

Kurosawa: "Sky Street. Collapse Level E."

Her voice has no rise or fall, as if reading a report unrelated to her.

Sparklink: "Level E? Sounds like the safest one."

Kurosawa: "Mhm. Or it might just be surface-level safety."

On the terminal, Liz's image emerges. Unstable signal frequencies make the holographic projection difficult. The outlines of her image are flickering light points that seem ready to vanish. She speaks.

Liz: "Let me reiterate the rules one last time. The gate is one-way. Unless the World Master personally opens a two-way channel, you cannot return."

Sparklink: "We know, we know. We already signed the risk waiver."

She smiles, though the smile lingers for a shorter time than usual.

Liz looks at the silent Kurosawa.

In Kurosawa's wordless eyes, there is something difficult to read. Is it worry? Or hesitation? They have heard these words many times, but this time, it seems to be knocking harder:

[Once you open this door, there is no turning back. Are you truly prepared?]

Kurosawa remains silent for a moment, then looks back at Sparklink—who responds with a smile, and she replies with one as well.

Kurosawa: "Mhm. Then, let us begin."

Sparklink grips Kurosawa's hand and whispers in her ear:

"I hope we don't hit a Bad Ending in Chapter 1."

The Light Gate opens before them.

On the other side of the door is Sky Street.

Twilight. Serenity. Gentleness. The wind chimes in the sky vaguely whisper; someone in a very distant place has struck an echo. The note is light, like melting snow. Every sway of the wind chimes falls in the same place.

They did not look back.

They continued to walk forward.

Scene 1-2: [Sky Street · Twilight]

(BGM: Gentle but with Static)

The Light Gate behind them completely stops breathing, leaving a void. The sound of the door closing is lighter than Kurosawa expected, like someone gently closing a book.

The sound of wind chimes comes from afar, spreading through Sky Street. The crowds are bustling. Shops by the street emit gentle light. The setting sun casts its last glow, illuminating the alleys under the twilight.

Sparklink gazes around, observing this world, and blinks.

Sparklink: "Isn't this quite normal? Is the file wrong?"

Kurosawa looks at a data projection in the air; her brow twitches slightly.

Kurosawa: "Abnormal numerical values detected."

Sparklink: "Where?"

Kurosawa: "Time flow deviation: 0.7 seconds."

Sparklink: "...Isn't that a bit too subtle?"

Kurosawa: "Errors do not occur naturally."

Kurosawa observes for a moment and looks into the distance—at the end of the street is a high tower. It isn't particularly tall or grand; it just stands there quietly. But when the twilight hits it, its color is deeper than its surroundings.

Kurosawa: "The source of the anomaly is there."

Sparklink quickens her pace to keep up with Kurosawa. She looks up, thinking about the meaning of 0.7 seconds in time. She asks:

"Wait, about that 0.7 seconds... if it's just a slight deviation, is it really a big deal?"

Kurosawa does not answer.

The two continue forward.

Scene 1-3: [Akatsuki's Temporary Residence]

They walked for a long time.

Or rather, Kurosawa wasn't sure how long they had walked. The twilight of Sky Street remained unchanged. That layer of golden light still hung on the eaves, exactly the same as when they first stepped through the gate.

The wind chimes were still ringing. One beat, then another. Like someone in the distance striking the same note with the same rhythm.

Sparklink counted her steps halfway. When she reached 327, she gave up.

Sparklink: "This place... does it have no night?"

Kurosawa did not answer. Her gaze remained fixed on the high tower. With every step, the tower seemed closer, yet it felt as if it stayed at the exact same distance.

Then, in a certain moment, between the repetitive strides, the tower suddenly loomed right before them.

The tower didn't get closer; it "appeared." Like a photograph suddenly changing its focal length.

Sparklink: "...How did we get here just now?"

Kurosawa still did not answer. She looked at the door at the base of the tower. The door was half-open.

It wasn't a wide-open welcome, nor a tightly shut rejection. It was just half-open—as if waiting for someone to push it open to enter, or for someone to push it to leave.

Kurosawa pushed the door open.

The light inside was dim, curtains half-drawn. Strands of twilight squeezed through the gaps, falling on the floor like strips of thin paper.

The air smelled of dust. The hourglass on the table was flowing backward—from bottom to top, grain by grain—like time retreating, like memory rewinding.

Sparklink stared at the hourglass for a full five seconds. She opened her mouth to speak but closed it again. —

Because there was someone else in the room.

She sat by the window, her back to them. The light fell on her, outlining a thin, bright edge. She was motionless, as if she had sat there for a very long time, as if she could sit there forever.

Akatsuki: "...You are late."

Her voice was soft. No blame, no emotion. Just stating a fact.

Sparklink: "Then what time would be considered 'early'?"

Akatsuki did not respond. Her gaze was locked onto the hourglass.

Akatsuki: "This world is no longer one of the three world lines on record."

Kurosawa: "The fourth?"

Akatsuki: "Perhaps."

When she said this, her tone was that of someone who had long accepted it. Not accepting a "fact," but accepting "no longer expecting"—a predetermined trajectory.

Sparklink: "Mhm... sounds like some hidden route in a game."

Akatsuki said softly:

"I am not joking... Nanoha is no longer here."

The air fell silent, save for the frictional sound of the hourglass flowing. It felt as if something had been sucked out, like breath being held, like a heartbeat skipping.

Sparklink: "No longer here... what does that mean?"

Akatsuki: "She was filtered out."

Kurosawa took a step forward. Her movement was light, but in this quiet room, the rustle of fabric sounded like a page being turned.

Kurosawa: "State the filtering mechanism."

Akatsuki reached out and picked up the hourglass.

The sand was still flowing backward. From bottom to top, grain by grain. Like someone picking up time piece by piece.

Akatsuki: "Every time time is rewound, it automatically excludes 'imperfect existences'."

Sparklink: "What are the criteria?"

Akatsuki: "Injury. Defect. Incompleteness."

She said these three words without any fluctuation in her tone. Like reciting a manual she had long memorized.

Sparklink: "Is this thing some kind of perfectionist AI?"

She didn't answer. She just looked at the hourglass. Watching the reverse-flowing sand. Silence flooded the room.

Akatsuki: "During the last rewind, Nanoha was injured while protecting me."

She paused—a very long pause. So long that Sparklink thought she wouldn't speak again.

"...And so, she was sent into the Fifth World Line."

Kurosawa's voice finally sounded. Light and steady.

Kurosawa: "Have you tried rewinding again?"

Akatsuki raised her head, looking at Kurosawa. In those eyes, there was finally something recognizable—fatigue.

Akatsuki: "Countless times."

Her voice grew even softer.

"But I... I never saw her again."

The sand in the hourglass continued to flow upward. One by one.

Outside, the light of twilight was still that same color. The wind chimes still rang. One beat, then another.

This world was constantly repeating.

...

And she was constantly waiting for her within the repetition.

Scene 1-4: [Restoration Operation]

Silence lingered in the room as the three sketched the Three-Phase World in their minds.

It lasted until the twilight outside seemed a bit darker—or perhaps it didn't.

Sparklink: "The core algorithm of this world is a self-strengthening filtration."

She looked down at the data pad in her hand, which she had just pulled up. Dense code crawled across the screen like insects; she read them one by one, filtering them line by line. This was her job: let the data speak, let the machine confess.

Kurosawa stood beside her, also looking at the data pad. She frowned.

Kurosawa: "The filtration criteria are expanding."

Sparklink's finger stopped on the screen. After a moment, she looked up at Kurosawa. In those eyes that usually held a smile, there was now something different.

Sparklink: "...Wait a minute."

"Does that mean—"

Kurosawa didn't let her finish. They understood.

Kurosawa: "This world will become more and more 'perfect'."

Her voice was calm.

Sparklink remembered the people she saw on the street earlier. Paces neither fast nor slow, expressions neither sad nor happy. Clean streets, gentle lights, the eternal twilight. The frozen glow of the setting sun, cast forever into the void of time.

Perfect.

The word suddenly felt very heavy.

Akatsuki's voice came from the window.

Akatsuki: "Mhm... and 'imperfect people' will disappear."

She didn't look back. Her voice remained flat. She was merely stating—stating a fact she had witnessed countless times.

Silence fell again, heavier this time.

Sparklink took a deep breath and let it out. She looked at Kurosawa.

Kurosawa wasn't looking at her. Kurosawa was looking at Akatsuki's back.

Kurosawa: "What do you want?"

Her question was short. Without any embellishment.

Akatsuki's shoulder moved slightly—the first tiny movement since they entered the room. Like someone who hadn't been asked a question in a long time suddenly being asked one.

She slowly turned around.

In those eyes, it was finally no longer that silence which was quieter than despair. There was something inside. Something burning.

Akatsuki: "I want her back."

Sparklink wanted to say something—wanted to say "we'll help you," "it can be done," all those things one should say in such a situation. But looking into Akatsuki's eyes, she suddenly couldn't say a word.

Because she knew those words were too light, so light that even a grain of sand could carry their weight.

Kurosawa didn't speak either. She just stood there, looking at Akatsuki. For a long, long time.

Then she gave a slight nod.

No promise. No guarantee. Just an action—*understood*.

Kurosawa: "We'll do it together."

The hourglass on the table began to vibrate violently. The reverse-flowing sand suddenly accelerated, as if time were frantically retreating, as if something were being forcibly pulled back from the past.

The curtains moved without wind.

The twilight outside—that eternal, unchanging twilight—suddenly flickered. Like an old film strip getting stuck on a frame.

Kurosawa looked up toward the distant high tower.

At the top of the tower, something was lighting up.

It wasn't light: it was something earlier than light. A premonition of "there will be light." Something that had been suppressed too many times and was finally about to burst out.

Akatsuki's eyes were fixed on the hourglass. Within the accelerating reverse-flowing sand, tiny specks of light began to appear. Like fireflies, fragments of memory. The "imperfect" existences that were filtered out during every rewind.

Kurosawa suddenly understood.

Kurosawa: "She is performing a reverse summoning."

Sparklink: "What?"

Kurosawa: "She is using her own rewinding to counter the world's filtration."

Kurosawa's voice was still calm, but Sparklink could hear it—something tightening beneath that calm.

Akatsuki's hands began to tremble. More and more light points appeared in the hourglass. They struggled, trying to break free from the reverse-flowing sand.

Like a drowning person struggling to reach the surface.

But the hourglass was fighting back.

Every time those light points rose a bit, they were dragged back by some force. Back and forth, in and out. Like an invisible tug-of-war. On one end of the rope was the filtration mechanism. On the other end was a person who didn't want to lose someone again.

Sparklink: "I'll help!"

Her hand pressed onto the data pad, and code began to scroll frantically. Her eyes scanned rapidly, her lips moving slightly—not speaking, but calculating. Finding a bug. Finding the gap that could pry the entire system open.

Kurosawa didn't move.

She stood in the center of the room, watching the scene. Watching Sparklink's back, watching Akatsuki's trembling hands. Watching those struggling light points in the hourglass.

Kurosawa remembered, before their first mission, Liz looking into her eyes and saying:

"Do not make decisions for the world."

She didn't understand then.

Now she understood a little. It wasn't "don't intervene." It was "don't assume you know what is right."

Because in this world, behind every "right," stands a sacrificed "wrong."

Is Akatsuki's choice right? — Unknown.

Is the filtration mechanism right? — Also unknown.

...

She only knew one thing.

The twilight outside was finally starting to darken.

It was the first night of Sky Street.

{PLAY: Marmalade Butcher's Song}

Scene 1-5: [Time Reversal Performance]

The first night of Sky Street has completely fallen.

It was as if someone had covered the entire sky with a black cloth.

The wind chimes stopped.

For the first time since they stepped into this world, there was no sound of wind chimes.

Without that sound, the silence became heavy.

Sparklink's data pad glowed in the night, the faint light reflecting on her face, making her expression flicker. The code was still scrolling, but her fingers had stopped.

Her voice was very soft.

Sparklink: "Akatsuki's energy is... I don't know how to describe it. It's diffusing. Overflowing. Like—"

She couldn't find a proper metaphor. But Kurosawa saw it.

The hourglass shattered.

It cracked slowly, like ice loosening when spring arrives. The reverse-flowing sand finally

stopped; it floated in the air, each grain wrapped in a faint glow. Light points multiplied, filling the entire room, then seeping out through the gaps of doors and windows, drifting into the depths of the night.

Akatsuki sat on her knees on the floor.

Her hands still held the pose of cupping the hourglass, but there was nothing left in them. Only some debris of light, like the remains of fireflies, slowly drifting from between her fingers.

She didn't cry.

She just looked at her hands, watched the light points drift away toward the distant darkness.

Akatsuki: "The Fifth World Line... its coordinates, I locked onto them countless times. But every time, every single time, I couldn't reach it."

Sparklink: "And this time?"

Akatsuki didn't answer.

...

In the distance, a light suddenly shone in the night. Like a sunrise, like a fire, like something rising from the earth.

Kurosawa turned to look out the window.

In the direction of the high tower, light was converging.

Not one beam, but countless beams. They surged from all directions, from those drifting light points, from the traces Akatsuki left in every rewind over the years. They were like rivers flowing into the sea, like memories finally finding their way home.

The top of the tower began to deform.

The texture of the stone loosened, began to rotate, and grew upward. The high tower that had been silent for centuries was now like a flowering tree, blooming with massive petals of brilliant light from its peak.

Sparklink stood up and walked to the window.

Kurosawa did not answer. She just watched.

Watching those lights converge into a shape. A blurred, forming shape.

Akatsuki suddenly stood up. Her movement was so fast she nearly tripped. She gripped the window frame, staring fixedly at the thing forming in the light. Her lips moved, but there was no sound.

The light slowly dissipated.

Like a curtain being drawn, like fog clearing.

A person fell to the ground. Like a feather finally ending its long journey, gently touching the earth.

She lay there, eyes closed. Her hair scattered on the ground, stained with debris of light.

Akatsuki pushed the window open.

She climbed over the sill and stumbled toward that person. The night swallowed her silhouette, with only the floating light points glowing faintly where she passed.

Sparklink wanted to chase after her, but Kurosawa held her back.

Kurosawa: "Wait."

Kurosawa's eyes were hard to see in the night, but her hand was steady.

"Let her go by herself."

...

In the distance, Akatsuki reached the person's side.

She knelt. She reached out, then pulled back. She was afraid. Afraid this was a dream, afraid she would wake if she touched her, afraid this was just another fleeting illusion from a rewind.

Then, that person opened her eyes.

Nanoha looked at her.

In those eyes, there was the daze of waking from a long sleep, the fatigue that hadn't quite vanished, and—something deeper than all of that. Her voice was raspy.

Nanoha: "I... was I not discarded?"

Akatsuki's tears fell.

She hugged her tightly, as if to reclaim every loss from all those years through this embrace.

Akatsuki: "I'm sorry."

Her voice was muffled in Nanoha's shoulder, hard to hear clearly. But Nanoha heard it.

She slowly raised her hand and placed it on Akatsuki's back.

Very lightly.

Like a leaf falling on the surface of the water.

...

In the distance, the night began to recede.

It wasn't dawn, but the floating light points were slowly dispersing. They had completed their mission; it was time to go.

The wind chimes rang again.

One beat, then another. Same as before, yet a little different.

Sparklink stood by the window, watching those two figures embracing in the distance. Kurosawa walked over to her side, and they watched together.

For a long, long time.

Sparklink: "What do you think we just did... what was that?"

Kurosawa didn't answer immediately.

The distant light points were still dispersing like a silent snowfall. Akatsuki and Nanoha's figures were blurred within that light, like a painting being completed.

Kurosawa: "I don't know."

This was the first time she said she didn't know.

Sparklink turned to look at her.

There was no expression on Kurosawa's face. But her eyes—those always calm eyes—now held something different.

Kurosawa: "But we did it."

Sparklink was stunned for a moment. Then she smiled.

Sparklink: "That's true."

She turned back to look out the window.

The light points were still drifting. Akatsuki was still holding Nanoha. The wind chimes were still ringing.

The twilight of Sky Street was slowly returning.

But it was no longer the twilight of a million repetitions—it was new.

Scene 1-6: [Anomalous Foreshadowing]

Sky Street recovered its colors, and the two-way gate was opened.

Sparklink: "Mission accomplished!"

Kurosawa, however, stared at the remains of the hourglass. The escaping light points told the story of what had happened here.

Kurosawa: "The filtration mechanism was not deleted; it was merely overwritten. The Fourth World Line has been fixed by us."

A certain data point flashed in the distance, further than where the wind chimes echoed.

Unknown Observation Record:

"Offset Value: +1."

The screen fades out.

Chapter 2: Celestial Area — The Disappearance of Universal Truth

Scene 2-0: [7sref · Brief Calm before Departure]

(BGM: Relaxed Electronic)

Sparklink sat on the console swinging her legs. Gray walls, blue light, eternal temperature. Before every mission, it was the same—she did the talking, Kurosawa the silence. She was the atmosphere-maker, Kurosawa the one who brought the atmosphere back.

Sparklink: "Don't you feel that repairing Sky Street was... a bit too smooth?"

Kurosawa was checking the shotgun authority interface.

Kurosawa: "Smooth does not equal correct."

Sparklink: "Eh? That sounds heavy."

Kurosawa looked up at her.

Kurosawa: "The filtration mechanism of the Sands of Time was not thoroughly deleted."

Sparklink: "But Nanoha came back..."

Kurosawa: "Mhm."

A very short sound. Like confirming, yet like hesitating.

Sparklink waited for two seconds, but no follow-up came.

Kurosawa: "The problem is—we fixed the Fourth World Line."

Sparklink: (Smiling, waving her hand) "Don't get all philosophical. You'll end up being the 'late-stage self-blaming heroine' if you keep this up."

Kurosawa didn't respond.

She was used to it.

But today, she felt something wasn't quite right.

Not with Kurosawa. With herself.

The images of Sky Street kept echoing in her mind—that eternal twilight, the reverse-flowing

sand, the person finally waited for after countless times.

What if she didn't wait long enough?

She suddenly thought.

What if Akatsuki hadn't waited? What if they hadn't gone? What if there were no light points in that hourglass?

While she was thinking, the air vibrated slightly. Liz's image appeared.

Liz: "Next, I would like you to prioritize handling the Celestial Area."

Sparklink: "Eeeh? But Heaven's collapse level is A+!"

Liz: "Yes. But the boundary between Heaven and the Demon Realm is disappearing."

Kurosawa: "Interfacial fusion?"

Liz: "More accurately—unilateral erosion."

Sparklink: "Doesn't sound fun."

Liz looked at Kurosawa.

Liz: "The authority of Aperuchike shall be handed to you."

A red light descended from the void. Not a piercing red, but a deep, dark red, like coagulated blood, or a setting sun about to fall. They coiled around Kurosawa's body, weaving a new silhouette over her original attire—sharper, heavier. The attire of a hunter.

Kurosawa looked down at her hands. The red light was receding, but the power remained. She could feel something beating in her chest—not a heartbeat, but a different rhythm. It was her resonance with this power.

Sparklink: "Whoa, that's cool."

Kurosawa: "Authority synchronization complete."

Liz: (Softly) "Remember, do not be hasty in judgment."

[Once you open this door, there is no turning back. Are you truly prepared?]

They had heard this many times. But this time, Sparklink suddenly didn't want to answer.

She walked over and stood beside Kurosawa.

The door slowly opened.

The light coming from the other side wasn't the gentle twilight of Sky Street—it was another color. Gray, purple, like something was rotting.

Kurosawa took a step, and Sparklink followed.

The door closed behind them.

Scene 2-1: [Celestial Area · Arrival]

(BGM: Oppressive Strings)

The sky wasn't black; it was purplish-black. It seemed saturated by some high-concentration energy, spreading and swallowing the remaining blue.

The grass was covered in a lifeless pitch-black, and a pungent burnt smell carried in the wind.

Sparklink frowned upon landing:

"Magic concentration... severely abnormal."

Kurosawa raised her gun to scan.

Kurosawa: "Energy attribute biased toward 'Destruction'."

Sparklink: "Is this... the attribute of the Demon Realm?"

Kurosawa: "Theoretically, the Demon Realm and Heaven are in balance."

Sparklink: "And now they're obviously out of balance."

A deafening explosion sounded from afar. A purple beam of light shot up.

The ashes under their feet were kicked up, drifting in the air. The wind grew stronger, and the rotting smell grew thicker. The purple light flickered on the horizon like a pulse, like breath, like something massive was waking up.

Sparklink: "Let's go!"

Heaven.

What should that name originally bring to mind?

Clouds. Light. Feathers. Songs.

She looked up at the sky.

The purple was still spreading. Only a tiny patch of blue remained, like the fingers of a drowning person reaching out of the water.

Then, even that last bit of blue vanished.

Scene 2-2: [Lucifer]

The two arrived at the center of the ruins.

...

Black wings unfurled, and a being in the form of a youth slowly descended. At the tips of his wings, dark purple light shed from his body—not as a calamity, but as existence itself.

Lucifer: "Observers."

Sparklink: "You know us?"

Lucifer: "Every time you intervene, you leave traces."

Kurosawa: "Explain the reason for the erosion."

Lucifer: (Chuckling) "Erosion?"

"This land belonged to me from the start."

Sparklink: "Records state the Heaven realm is the main realm."

Lucifer: "Records are written by the winners."

Kurosawa raised her hand, aiming at Lucifer.

Lucifer waved his hand, and a purple torrent pressed down. In every crack of this world, in every inch of air. It pressed down, not with force, but with the inevitability of "it was always supposed to be here."

Kurosawa's mechanically stable hand fired precisely at Lucifer.

However, the bullet tore through the air, entered the purple mist, and vanished silently.

Sparklink: "Whoa?! Damage detection was swallowed?!"

Lucifer: "What you use are 'Heaven's rules'."

The wind grew even stronger.

The purple began to churn like a sea, as if something was waking up in the depths.

"And the rules here are being rewritten."

Scene 2-3: [Retreat and Discussion]

They retreated to a dilapidated temple.

To call it a temple was an exaggeration; only a few pillars remained. The roof was long gone, and the purple sky pressed overhead like it might collapse at any moment. Sparklink set up defense devices around the pillars; the small machines hummed, propping up a thin barrier.

Sparklink: "That guy isn't an ordinary enemy."

Kurosawa: "Not an 'enemy'."

Sparklink: "Here you go again?"

Kurosawa: "He is maintaining some kind of order."

Sparklink stopped her movements.

Sparklink: "You aren't considering a negotiation, are you?"

Kurosawa: "If the Demon Realm isn't a mistake—"

Sparklink: (Interrupting) "Then what about the Heaven realm?"

The silence was deafening.

Sparklink sighed:

"Kurosawa, you're an observer, not a philosopher."

Kurosawa: "Shouldn't an observer understand rules even more?"

Sparklink wanted to argue but didn't know how. She knew Kurosawa was right. But "right" and "capable of being done" were two different things.

Outside the barrier, the purple was still churning.

Scene 2-4: [Acid's Appearance]

Suddenly, in the air not far away, a purple umbrella bloomed.

Kurosawa hurried to aim her shotgun at it.

Looking closely, it was Acid appearing leisurely. The two breathed a sigh of relief.

Acid: "My, my, getting pressed, are we?"

Sparklink: "Are you here to help or just to watch?"

Acid folded her umbrella.

Acid: "Oh dear, your shotguns haven't been charged yet."

Sparklink: "It's a bit too late for a newbie tutorial now!"

Kurosawa: "Charging method?"

Acid: "Wishes."

Sparklink: "What kind of wishes?"

Acid: "The wishes of the people who want Heaven to be restored."

Kurosawa: "What about the wishes of the Demon Realm?"

Acid narrowed her eyes. In those eyes, for the first time, there was something different—perhaps interest, perhaps surprise, or perhaps something even more complex.

Acid: "...You really are a dangerous child."

Scene 2-5: [Convergence of Wishes]

After retreating further, the two finally found the remnants of the Four Beast Tribes and the survivors of the priesthood.

The remnants of the Four Beast Tribes huddled in a corner, their fur stained with ash, their eyes holding a numbness born of being defeated too many times. A few priests sat on the other side, heads bowed, unsure if they were praying or dazed.

Beast Chief: "Goddess Dana must not disappear."

Priest: "Lord Yurisaki Mika is still in the temple."

Sparklink: "Kurosawa, the wish values are rising now."

Kurosawa felt the authority fluctuate. Wishes converged like light particles. Those wishes were like tiny glimmers, drifting out from these people's bodies, strand by strand, thread by thread, gathering upon her. They were light, almost weightless. But they were also heavy—so heavy she could feel that every time a strand drifted out, those people dimmed just a little bit.

Her hand trembled slightly.

Kurosawa watched the converging light beams, falling into deep thought.

Kurosawa: "After the wishes are extracted, what will they lose?"

Acid: (Whispering) "Wishes were meant to dissipate eventually. You are merely accelerating it."

Kurosawa closed her eyes.

"Charging complete."

{PLAY: 米虾 Fomiki & 出云 Cloudie's Song}

Scene 2-6: [The Decisive Battle]

(BGM: Climax Battle)

Lucifer unfurled a massive magic circle.

The sky tore open behind him. The purple pieces fell down like shredded cloth, revealing what lay behind. Behind was nothing but deeper darkness.

Sparklink activated her thrusters.

Sparklink: "I'll draw his fire!"

Kurosawa aimed.

Lucifer looked at her:

"Observer, do you know what you are doing?"

Kurosawa: "I am preventing an imbalance."

Lucifer: "Imbalance itself is a form of balance."

Sparklink: "Don't let him talk you out of it!"

Kurosawa fired.

A seven-colored torrent of wishes gushed from the barrel. Not bullets, but light. Not one beam, but countless beams—every beam contained a wish, every beam contained a voice saying "I want Heaven to be restored." They merged together, tearing through the purple, tearing through the magic circle, tearing through the youth standing in the center of the ruins.

Lucifer's body began to disintegrate.

He smiled bitterly as he spoke his final words:

"By destroying me, you also destroy a part of Celestial Area."

The purple mist dispersed.

The sky returned to a clear azure.

Scene 2-7: [Restoration]

Yurisaki Mika sang once more the song belonging only to Celestial Area. The song fell upon the ruins, and grass began to sprout. It fell upon the ashes, and ashes turned into soil. It fell upon those numb faces, and people began to cry.

The meadows were restored. People cheered.

Sparklink twirled:

"We did it!"

Kurosawa, however, stood still.

She looked around, watching the recovering grass, the weeping people, and the silhouette of Yurisaki Mika standing high up and singing.

Kurosawa: "The Demon realm has completely vanished."

Sparklink: "Isn't that a good thing?"

Kurosawa: "The balance has been broken."

Sparklink fell silent.

Remote Data Record:

Heaven Stability: 100%

Demon Realm Existence: 0%

Offset Value: +3

Scene 2-8: [Return to 7sref]

The gate opened.

The two returned.

7sref was the same as ever. Gray walls, blue light, eternal temperature.

Liz did not smile.

Liz: "The Demon Realm has vanished."

Kurosawa: "Yes."

Liz: "You did not attempt to reconcile."

Sparklink: "Time did not allow it."

Liz: "Time never allows it."

Her voice was soft. In those transparent eyes, there was no blame, no disappointment. Only something very light—perhaps understanding, perhaps helplessness.

"But the choice was yours."

Kurosawa avoided eye contact for the first time. She looked at the floor, at her own shadow, at the tiny light points flickering at the edges of her shadow.

The screen fades out.

Chapter 3: Black Rose Area — The Abandoned Perfection

Scene 3-0: [Black Rose Region · Night]

(BGM: Mysterious & Tense)

The train speeds through the night.

The sound of wheels rolling over the tracks—one beat, then another—like a heartbeat, like a countdown, like something is approaching. Nothing can be seen outside the window—no lights, no villages, no moon. Only black, a black so thick it won't dissolve.

Sparklink stands by the carriage window, staring at a word written in blood on the glass.

"F".

The strokes are messy, written by a dying finger dipped in its own blood. The last stroke is dragged out long, all the way to the edge of the window frame.

Sparklink: "Is this... 'F'? Maybe the first letter of the wealthy merchant's name?"

Kurosawa walks to her side, her gaze calm.

Kurosawa: "No, that's not right. He likely wanted to tell us something else."

She turns her gaze out the window, feeling an underlying unease.

Sparklink looks down at the data pad. On it is the merchant's profile—name, age, occupation, time of death. Everything is normal, so normal it's abnormal.

If it's not the first letter of a name, what is it?

The train turns a corner. The carriage shakes slightly, and the blood-letter on the glass trembles as if alive.

A whistle blows from afar.

Light and distant. Like it's coming from another world.

Scene 3-1: [Steam Train Carriage · Carriage 15]

Aoul pushes the door open and walks in.

He wears an old trench coat, the hem stained with night mist. From the moment he enters, his gaze is fixed on the blood-letter. He looks, and looks—until everyone else in the carriage thinks he won't speak.

Then he speaks.

Aoul: "The merchant's death seems related to the 'Black Rose Disease,' but according to Sparklink's analysis, the progression was too sudden to be natural."

Sparklink: "I checked the merchant's vitals; they are indeed typical symptoms of the Black Rose Disease, but..."

Kurosawa suddenly turns around.

Kurosawa: "But I don't think he died of the disease; he died of some human intervention."

Aoul: "You're right, Kurosawa. I suspect there's a mastermind."

Kurosawa: "The letter F, the merchant's last words..."

Her eyes suddenly light up, her gaze fixing on the door of Carriage 15.

"Let's go to Carriage 15."

Scene 3-2: [Carriage 15 • Eerie Encounter]

When the door of Carriage 15 is pushed open, it makes a light creak.

No one is inside. —

At least not at first glance. The seats are neatly arranged, curtains half-drawn, a cup of tea still steaming on the table—as if someone had just been sitting here and only left for a moment.

Sparklink walks in, looking around.

Kurosawa stands at the door, motionless. She is listening. Listening for any sounds that shouldn't be there in the air.

Aoul walks to the table and looks down at the tea. There are fine ripples on the surface, as if something just floated up and sank back down.

Eli: "You've finally arrived."

The voice comes from the corner.

Cold. Light. Like it drifted from far away, yet also like it was always there and only just decided to be heard.

Kurosawa's gun muzzle swings over instantly.

A girl stands in the corner. Black dress, black hair, black eyes. She stands there, who knows for how long—perhaps she had been there since the train departed.

Sparklink frowns slightly; Kurosawa coldly scans the surroundings.

Sparklink: "Who are you? Why are you here?"

Eli does not answer directly. Instead, she looks toward the other side of the carriage as the Phantom Thief Hedelu slowly steps out of the shadows.

Hedelu: "The Black Rose Disease has begun to spread. Eli is the source of the collapse in this region; as long as she dies, the world of the Black Rose can return to normal."

Kurosawa sneers and quickly draws her shotgun, pointing it at Hedelu.

Kurosawa: "You think a few words will make me believe you?"

Hedelu only chuckles, his expression utterly cold.

Hedelu: "Killing me is meaningless; Eli is the one who truly should die. If you want to save this region, you have to make a choice."

Kurosawa does not back down. However, Sparklink pulls her hand.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa, calm down. We need more information."

Kurosawa's gaze sweeps over Hedelu; she seems to sense something but does not relax her guard.

Kurosawa: "So, Eli can really solve this disaster?"

Hedelu: "Her existence is the 'error' of this region."

Scene 3-3: [Eli's Choice]

Eli speaks softly, breaking the deadlock.

Eli: "I am willing to destroy myself."

Her words are calm and resolute.

"Only if I vanish can the Black Rose Disease be completely eradicated and the region restored."

Kurosawa stares at Eli, questions swirling in her heart.

Kurosawa: "Why... why would you do this? Do you have no other choice?"

Eli falls silent, pain flickering in her eyes.

She remains silent for a long time.

Long enough that the air in the carriage begins to get heavy, long enough that the night outside begins to seep in.

Eli: "This is the final atonement I can make for this world."

Aoul suddenly stands up, stepping quickly toward Eli, his eyes shining with sudden realization.

Aoul: "No! You're wrong! You cannot solve the problem through self-destruction!"

Eli: "I have no choice, Aoul. The collapse of this region is fundamentally because of me. Only if I disappear can balance be restored."

Aoul opens his mouth but says nothing.

Kurosawa watches this scene. Looking at Eli's eyes, at Aoul's hanging hand, at Sparklink standing aside, biting her lip.

Her finger is still on the trigger, but she does not fire.

{PLAY: tailspun's Song}

Scene 3-4: [Enveloped by the Black Rose]

At that moment, the power of the Black Rose begins to spread within the carriage. From all directions, from every crack, from every corner of the air. They are like vines, like tentacles, like countless hands stretching out from the darkness, crawling over windows, seats, and the ceiling.

Sparklink: "No! It's swallowing the entire region!"

Kurosawa's gaze becomes firm.

Kurosawa: "We cannot let this continue!"

She aims at Eli, preparing to fire.

However, Eli uses all her strength to stretch out her hand, forcibly resisting the spread of the Black Rose.

Eli: "This is my final choice. I have decided."

Her body begins to turn transparent. The Black Rose envelops her, turning transparent as well—like glass, like water, like light. The seats behind her become visible, as do the frozen Black Roses and Aoul's rushing figure.

"Goodbye..."

Eli's voice drifts, then scatters in the air.

Sparklink: "Wait!"

But her words are useless; Eli has already vanished within the Black Rose's embrace.

The entire region begins to disintegrate, the power of the Black Rose slowly receding.

Like a tide pulling back, like fog clearing. They withdraw from windows, seats, and the ceiling. Everything left is as it was—but one person is gone.

The carriage falls quiet.

Aoul stands in place, his hand still outstretched, frozen at the spot where Eli disappeared.

Sparklink slowly lowers her hand.

Kurosawa's gun muzzle drops.

A distant whistle blows. Light and far away. Like a farewell.

Scene 3-5: [Back to 7sref]

As the Black Rose dissipates, Kurosawa and Sparklink find a new gate before them.

It emits a seven-colored glow, as if representing the rebirth of hope.

Sparklink: "Did we... succeed?"

Kurosawa remains silent, deep in thought.

She stands by the window, looking at the glass. The blood-letter "F" is still there, but the color has faded, so faint it's almost invisible. Like the words the person wanted to say before death, finally washed away by time.

Kurosawa: "Is it repaired?"

Sparklink: "Yes! This is the gate that opens to 7sref!"

Kurosawa looks down in contemplation.

Kurosawa: "What did we do?"

Sparklink: "What?"

Kurosawa: "If Eli chose self-destruction... then we did nothing. We were just bystanders."

She looks at the gate, feeling empty inside.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa, stop overthinking it. Let's go. The next stop is..."

She takes Kurosawa's hand. She wants to say "but we came," "we witnessed," all the things one should say. But looking into Kurosawa's eyes, she suddenly can't say anything.

Kurosawa: "...Next stop."

She doesn't speak again, silently following Sparklink toward the gate.

Scene 3-6: [Other side of the Gate]

The two pass through the gate and return to 7sref.

Liz stands at the console, looking at them. She doesn't ask for the result—the data is already displayed on the panel. The numbers are like breathing, like waiting, like reminding them of something.

Kurosawa: "We restored the region... but it didn't return to the form it should have had."

Sparklink: "Mhm, maybe it was fixed, but we didn't actually change anything."

Kurosawa: "This might just be the role of a bystander."

Sparklink smiles:

"It's fine, let's keep moving."

She pulls Kurosawa forward. The next stop is still full of uncertainty.

They continue to step forward.

Chapter 3 Completion Record

Sky Street: +1

Heaven: +3

Black Rose: +7

Cumulative Offset Value: +11

Chapter 4: Metropolis Area — The Stagnant Lost Civilization

Scene 4-0: [7sref · Before Departure]

(BGM: Relaxed)

Sparklink spreads a pile of data chips on the table with a "clatter." The chips roll around; a few reach the edge and nearly fall off. She scoops them back, tossing two more in for good measure.

Sparklink: "Finally, it's my home turf! Hahahaha!"

Kurosawa: "Metropolis Area. Collapse level unobservable."

Sparklink: "Sounds like it means 'no problem'."

She looks at the chips, at the faint glow on the data interfaces. These were things she was familiar with—so familiar she could operate them with her eyes closed. Sparklink's world, the world of technology. A place where everything could be explained with data.

Kurosawa: "'Unobservable' is more dangerous than 'High Level'."

Sparklink: "You're getting more and more pessimistic lately."

Kurosawa paused for a second. She thought of the fading "F" of the Black Rose Area, the vanished Demon Realm of Celestial Area, the eternal twilight of Sky Street Area.

Kurosawa: "About that Black Rose matter..."

Sparklink stands up, walks to her, and pats her shoulder.

Sparklink: "Stop thinking about it. Listen to me this time. Technological problems should be solved with technology!"

Liz's projection appeared again.

Liz: "The anomaly of the Metropolis Area is 'Stagnation'."

Sparklink: "Stagnation counts as collapse?"

Liz: "When a civilization stops moving toward the future, it has already begun to decay."

Kurosawa: (Softly) "Unless... they chose it voluntarily."

Liz looks at her. In those transparent eyes, something flashes—perhaps surprise, or perhaps a more complex emotion. But she doesn't answer.

[Once you open this door, there is no turning back. Are you truly prepared?]

The door opens once more.

Scene 4-1: [Metropolis • Arrival]

(BGM: Bright Electronic)

High-rises. Overpasses. Flight tracks intersect in the sky like countless glowing rivers. Screens on the streets play advertisements; models in the videos smile, showing exactly 8 teeth. The streets are so clean they reflect everything like mirrors.

Sparklink spreads her arms:

"Now *this* is the place I'm familiar with!"

Kurosawa opens her scanner. Data flows before her eyes—air quality, population density, traffic flow, energy consumption. Every item is beautiful, so beautiful it looks fake.

Kurosawa: "Social stability: 99.8%."

Sparklink: "That's great."

Kurosawa: "Technology growth rate: 0%."

Sparklink: "...Huh?"

Kurosawa: "It has been stagnant for... fifty years."

Sparklink's smile fades slightly. She looks around at the high-rises, the flight tracks, the clean streets. Everything is good, too good, so good that there seems to be no need for change.

Fifty years.

This city hasn't changed in fifty years.

Scene 4-2: [Tenshou Pavilion • Kurohime]

Kurohime stands before a transparent floor-to-ceiling window. Outside is a panorama of the Metropolis. The high-rises stand like a forest, with flight tracks threading through them like glowing vines. She watches all this without expression.

Kurohime: "Welcome, Observers."

Sparklink: "You're doing quite well here."

Kurohime: "We used to develop even faster."

Kurosawa: "Why stop?"

Kurohime turns around.

Kurohime: "Because we calculated the end."

The air fell silent.

Sparklink: "The end?"

Kurohime: "Newt predicted the future. If we continue advancing technology, the civilization will be destroyed in two hundred and thirty-seven years."

Sparklink fell silent.

Kurosawa: "Cause of destruction?"

Kurohime: "The cause will be... an uncontrollable energy device failure. This failure will not only turn the entire Metropolis into dust but also destroy the entire world—including the 7sref region."

Sparklink: (Softly) "Is this... Pandora-level?"

Kurohime: "Similar."

Kurosawa's pupils contracted.

She didn't know how to respond.

Scene 4-3: [Conflict of Ideas]

Sparklink: "Then let's improve the prediction!"

Kurohime: "The probability of such a future is as high as 95%."

Sparklink: "Then there's still a 5% hope!"

Kurohime: "No! We would rather choose that 95% of safety."

Kurosawa speaks. Her voice is soft, but every word is clear.

Kurosawa: "Stagnation equals slow death."

Kurohime: "Slow death is better than instant destruction."

Silence falls over the three.

Kurohime continues:

"Observers, you always encourage the world to move forward. But you do not bear the consequences."

Sparklink: "We lose things too."

She thinks of Sky Street, Heaven, and the Black Rose. They indeed did not bear those consequences. The ones who bore them were Akatsuki, Yurisaki Mika, and Eli.

Kurosawa: (Softly) "She is right."

Sparklink looks at her.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa?"

Kurosawa: "If stagnation is their choice..."

Sparklink grits her teeth:

Sparklink: "But don't you think this is like giving up?!"

Scene 4-4: [The Challenge]

The door is pushed open.

Shi_Koku and Kao_Rai arrive aggressively. Both wear combat suits with weapons hanging at their waists.

Shi_Koku: "Observers."

"If you think the future is worth a try, then please prove it with your strength."

Kao_Rai: "The winner among us shall ultimately hold control over Newt."

Sparklink, without hesitation: "Bring it on!"

Kurosawa: "..."

Sparklink looks back at Kurosawa.

Sparklink: "You won't back down, will you?"

Kurosawa slowly nods.

"No."

Thus, the challenge is set. The lever of the future is pulled in a clash that stops just short of life and death.

{PLAY: BilliumMoto's Song}

Scene 4-5: [The Battle]

(BGM: High-Intensity Electronic)

Shi_Koku swings his Ship-Cutter Greatsword. The sword is larger than a person, but in his hand, it's as light as a twig. As the blade cuts through the air, it leaves a white trail—the sound of air being torn. Kurosawa raises her Magic Flute; the flute's sound begins, not as music, but as something more ancient. Space begins to warp; the air around Shi_Koku becomes viscous, and his movements slow down.

Sparklink activates her flight device. Kao_Rai unfolds an aerial defense matrix.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa, cover me!"

Kurosawa: "Weakening the defense layers now."

Shi_Koku struggles, trying to break through the warped space. His sword cleaves the air, the light, and everything in his path—but for every layer he cleaves, a new one surges up.

Shi_Koku's voice echoes from the warped space.

Shi_Koku: "You are merely accelerating destruction."

Kurosawa: "The future is not fixed."

Sparklink releases a virus; the defense matrix begins to malfunction, beams no longer aiming but firing randomly. Kao_Rai falls from the sky, crashing to the ground and kicking up a cloud of dust.

Shi_Koku's greatsword finally stops.

He kneels on the ground, blood at the corner of his mouth. He looks at Kurosawa, at her Magic Flute, and at the warped space behind her slowly returning to normal.

The battle is over.

Metropolis's technology, when faced with 7sref and the obsession with saving the future, was fragile.

Scene 4-6: [Newt]

Kurohime remains silent for a long time.

Kurohime: "You have won."

Sparklink: "Restart Newt."

Kurosawa: "Using the Magic Flute to 'awaken'."

Kurohime: "I must warn you once more... what you are awakening this time isn't just calculations!"

Kurosawa: "I know."

The flute sounds.

This time it isn't the flute of battle, but something else—lighter, gentler, like calling out to someone who has slept for too long.

Newt's core begins to glow.

Light surges from the depths of the console, from the cracks in the floor, from the pipes in the ceiling. They converge into a massive pillar of light, piercing through the roof of Tenshou Pavilion, the sky of the Metropolis, and this land that had been stagnant for fifty years.

The city begins to vibrate. The chime of rebirth rings softly.

The land embracing a new life is waking up, stretching, and beginning to breathe again.

The screens on the street flicker, then light up with new, vivid, living images.

The lights on the flight tracks change color. Those colors that hadn't changed for fifty years begin to flow, change, and chase each other.

"Technology growth rate: 0% → 0.1% → 0.5% → 1%"

Sparklink smiles.

Sparklink: "The future is flowing again!"

Scene 4-7: [Anomaly]

Just as Sparklink is happily dancing, Kurosawa frowns while staring at the data.

Kurosawa: "Data anomaly."

Sparklink: "Where?"

Kurosawa: "The Hidden History Module has been unsealed."

Kurohime's face changes slightly.

Kurohime: "That... that is the Forbidden Zone."

Sparklink: "What? Forbidden Zone?"

Newt calmly broadcasts:

"End-Time Device Development Record—Unlocked prematurely."

The air grows cold.

Kurosawa: (Softly) "The Magic Flute's 'awakening'..."

Sparklink: "Did it awaken future technologies too?!"

A structural diagram appears on the screen: a massive spiral device, winding layer by layer like DNA, like an infinity symbol, like something that shouldn't exist.

Kurosawa's pupils contract.

"That is... the Pandora Prototype."

Scene 4-8: [Consequences]

Kurohime: (Softly) "This thing was supposed to appear three thousand years from now."

Sparklink: "Did we... advance history?"

Kurosawa: "Not advance."

"Unseal."

Sparklink is speechless for the first time.

Remote Data Record:

Technology Acceleration Index: +40

History Advancement: +3000 years

Three thousand years.

With one choice, they made this city sprint three thousand years.

Scene 4-9: [Return]

The gate back to 7sref opens before them.

Kurohime stands at the gate, seeing them off. She doesn't speak, and her expression is unreadable. But the light from the gate falls on her, casting a very long shadow.

Sparklink walks very slowly.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa."

Kurosawa: "Mhm."

Sparklink: "If the future really is going to be destroyed..."

"Did we just press the fast-forward button for it?"

Kurosawa remains silent.

Kurosawa: "We chose possibility."

Sparklink: "Possibility includes faster destruction."

Kurosawa does not answer.

Scene 4-10: [7sref]

Liz watches them.

Liz: "Newt has been restarted."

Kurosawa: "Yes."

Liz: "History advanced."

Sparklink: (Bowing her head) "Yes."

Liz: (Softly) "The offset value has exceeded the threshold."

She knows those numbers aren't just math. They won't wait until 30 for something to happen. Things have been happening, accumulating, waiting for the moment when all problems are laid bare.

The air grows heavy.

The screen fades out.

Chapter 4 Completion Record

Sky Street: +1

Heaven: +3

Metropolis: +7

Black Rose: +15

Cumulative Offset Value: +26

Warning: Fluctuations in the Departure Area are strengthening.

Chapter 5: Dragon Area — The Frozen Wasteland World

Scene 5-0: [7sref · Before Departure]

(BGM: Low)

Sparklink stares at the offset value.

Sparklink: "It's already... 26."

Kurosawa: "Nearing the threshold."

Sparklink: "What is the threshold?"

Liz: "30."

The air grows cold instantly.

Sparklink: "Then the Dragon Area is—"

Liz: "The last region that has not yet completely collapsed."

Kurosawa: "After that is the Departure Area."

Liz: "Yes."

She looks at Kurosawa.

"Do not make decisions for the world."

Kurosawa remains silent.

The gate opens. They walk toward the next door.

That door hasn't lit up yet, but light is already surging within it.

On the other side of the door is a frozen wasteland.

The anger of the Dragon Race.

And everything they have yet to face.

Scene 5-1: [Frozen Wasteland]

(BGM: Hollow Cold Wind)

The sky is gray-white, the earth cracked by ice—a vast wasteland.

Dragons fly low in the sky; they blot out the sun, and the shadows they cast are heavier than clouds.

Sparklink: "The file says this place was once covered in forests. Now it's..."

Kurosawa: "Ecological index dropped by 78%."

Suddenly, a nearby group of dragons dives; fire brushes past Sparklink's shoulder.

Sparklink activates her shield:

"Their hostility is too high! Run!!"

A dragon's roar vibrates, stopping the group. It is LED shouting from nearby. He is a dragon with an orange-yellow body, emerald green eyes, and a single snowy white horn.

LED: "Stop!"

The dragons scatter under his command. Ask and Embera follow closely behind LED.

Ask: "You don't look like locals."

Kurosawa: "We are Observers from 7sref."

Ask: (Sneering) "Then you're late."

Scene 5-2: [The Start of Truth]

By the bonfire, the flow of time tells of powerlessness. The blue flames hiss and sigh hoarsely, without warmth.

LED narrates softly.

LED: "In ancient times, the Dragon Race and humans signed a contract."

Sparklink: "The content was... to protect humans?"

LED: "Yes. We truly hoped to achieve coexistence with humans."

Kurosawa: "Coexistence conditions?"

LED falls silent for a moment.

"Resource sharing."

Sparklink: "Sounds fair enough."

LED: (Looking up) "Until... humans began to hunt dragons."

The air freezes instantly.

Kurosawa: "It was never mentioned in the records."

LED: (Sneering) "After all, records are written by humans."

Scene 5-3: [History Playback]

Memory images manifest in the air.

They weren't actively summoned; they appeared on their own—as if this land finally found someone willing to listen and couldn't wait to lay everything out.

Humans were expanding.

First, forests were cut down, and the habitats of the Dragon Race vanished piece by piece. Then came the rivers; industrial waste was dumped in, the water turned black, and fish floated

up on their bellies. Finally, the contract itself—humans began hunting the dragons.

Not for survival, but for more endless plunder.

Dragon scales became energy. Dragon hearts became the cores of power machines. Dragon blood was bottled, labeled, and priced.

In the image, there is a dragon, very small, perhaps a cub. It is tied to a platform, surrounded by people in white coats. It doesn't struggle; it just looks at the camera—perhaps not the camera, but something behind it. That look is something Sparklink would never forget.

The images vanish.

The bonfire is still burning, blue flames jumping without warmth.

Sparklink: (Softly) "This... isn't in the files."

LED: "Humans broke the contract. Dragons retaliated. The contract collapsed."

Ask: "Now the Dragon Race believes—"

"That protecting humans is a mistake."

Kurosawa closes her eyes.

Is this a mistake?

Scene 5-4: [The Solution]

LED: "At this point, only by re-signing the contract can we stop the war."

Sparklink: "Then, do we need to summon the Dragon King?"

LED nods.

Kurosawa: "Then who will represent humanity?"

Silence. The bonfire jumps, making everyone's shadows flicker and stretch.

Ask looks at Kurosawa.

"You."

Sparklink: (Stunned) "Us?!"

LED: "You have already made choices for the other regions. We believe in you."

Kurosawa: (Softly) "We have no right."

LED looks at her. In those green eyes, something is jumping—perhaps understanding, perhaps helplessness, or a more complex emotion.

LED: "But you possess authority."

The air is heavy. Those jumping blue flames look at their own long shadows on the ground.

They have gained too much authority. But what about the right? Who gives them the right to make choices for others?

A dragon's roar echoes from afar.

Long and deep, like an urge, and like a wait.

Scene 5-5: [The Altar]

With the aid of illusion magic, everyone crosses the ice fields to the Dragon Altar.

It is a massive stone platform surrounded by countless stone pillars, each carved with ancient runes. When the wind blows, the runes glow, flickering like breath.

The Dragon King descends.

Its body blots out the sun; when its wings unfurl, the sky turns dark. Each scale is large enough to cover the heavens, and each claw tip is like a giant sword driven into the ground. It looks down at them, at those tiny human forms standing on the stone platform.

Dragon King: "Are you the representatives of humanity?"

Kurosawa steps forward.

Kurosawa: "We hope to rebuild the contract."

Dragon King: "Where are the wishes of humanity?"

Kurosawa takes out a Wish Crystal. The crystal glows in her hand, filled with countless tiny light points—the voices of humans, the requests of humans, the wishes of humans wanting to live.

Dragon King: "And the wishes of the Dragon Race?"

Silence. The silence is heavy, pressing on the altar, pressing on everyone's hearts.

Sparklink: (Whispering) "Kurosawa?"

Dragon King: (Vibrating voice) "You have only brought the wishes of humans."

Kurosawa looks up.

Kurosawa: "What are the wishes of the Dragon Race?"

Dragon King: "To be respected."

The air is silent.

{PLAY: Kolaa's Song}

Scene 5-6: [The Priest's Attack]

A priest rushes out of the shadows.

A dark blur flashes by, and Sparklink's defense field emits a piercing scream. Cracks appear on the light shield, spreading like ice being smashed.

Priest: "Lord Dragon King! Do not believe the humans! A contract is a painful shackle! Have you forgotten the past agony?"

"If you don't make up your mind, I'll swallow these little things whole first!"

The High Priest violently attacks the group. Sparklink reacts quickly, opening a defense field to block the attack.

Ask and Embera assist from the side, pinning down the High Priest.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa! Hurry! We can't hold out much longer!"

Kurosawa stands dazed in the center, her face full of hesitation, finally looking toward the Dragon King with a frown.

Kurosawa: "If we sign the contract, does it mean making a decision for the Dragon Race again?"

Dragon King: "The responsibility of the contract must be borne by someone."

Kurosawa's body jolts. Turning her head, she sees the High Priest about to break free from the trio's restraint. Fire and frost converge in mid-air, clashing and bursting.

She finally closes her eyes and raises the Magic Flute. The flute emits a golden light.

This time, the sound of the flute is not awakening the wishes of humans—it is awakening the

memories of the Dragon Race.

Golden light surges from the flute, not toward the Dragon King, but toward the void behind it. Images emerge in the light—

Humans and dragons fighting side by side.

A human bandaging an injured dragon.

A human and a dragon sitting together, watching the same starry sky.

Those images are so distant that even the Dragon King had almost forgotten them. But they are still there, in the deepest part of memory, at the moment the contract was first signed.

The light condenses into a crystal.

It is the hope the Dragon Race held when they first chose to believe in humanity.

Kurosawa reaches out, catching the crystal.

"A new contract," she says. "Signed by both parties."

The Dragon King watches her.

For a long time.

"Established."

The light of the contract rises from the altar, piercing through the ice fields, the sky, and this land that has been frozen by hatred for too long.

The priest stops.

He stands there, watching the light, watching the images in the light, watching that something which hasn't appeared in a long time slowly emerge in the Dragon King's eyes.

The dragons begin to land.

They land on the ice fields, on the ruins, on the places once charred by fire. They no longer attack.

Scene 5-7: [The Price]

The ice begins to melt. The forest is slowly recovering. The vitality of the past gushes out once more.

Sparklink: "We succeeded."

Kurosawa, however, remains standing still.

Kurosawa: "We are still interveners."

Sparklink: "But this time both sides agreed."

Kurosawa: "Yes."

In the distance, the girl with the purple umbrella appears again.

Acid: (Whispering) "You two, you've finally learned to hesitate."

Acid walks out from the void, umbrella in hand. She walks to the priest, reaches out, and pulls a strand of light from his forehead—a memory crystal.

Acid: (Scoffing with a smile) "The dragons broke the contract first... because humans were hunting them on a massive scale. (Chuckles) Justice is never one-sided, you know."

Acid says no more. She holds her umbrella, turns into the void, and vanishes.

Scene 5-8: [Return]

Another two-way gate opens. Sparklink's reaction is the complete opposite of before; she remains silent for a long time.

A two-way door: one can return, or go again. This is the first time the door did not close behind them when they left a area.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa."

Kurosawa: "Mhm."

Sparklink: "If humans keep making mistakes, are we correcting the world, or the humans?"

Kurosawa looks up at Sparklink.

Kurosawa: "Perhaps neither."

Sparklink: "Then what?"

Kurosawa: "We are just pushing the world in a certain direction."

Sparklink: "Which way?"

Kurosawa: "..."

Kurosawa does not answer.

Wind blows from the other side of the gate, carrying the scentless scent unique to 7sref.

They walk in.

The door slowly closes behind them, emitting a final sigh.

Scene 5-9: [7sref]

Liz: "Contract reconstruction successful."

Kurosawa: "Yes."

Liz: "Signed by both parties?"

Kurosawa: "Yes."

Liz nods slightly.

"However, the offset value still rises."

Sparklink is stunned: "Why?!"

Data emerges:

Dragon Race Power Balance Changed

History Trajectory Rewritten

Offset Value: +4

Cumulative Offset Value: +30

Warning:

[Departure Area Instability]

The air in 7sref suddenly turns cold. Grave expressions appear on the faces of all three.

Liz: "The threshold... has been reached after all."

Kurosawa: (Softly) "Finally, we have to face it."

She looks at the distant door, the door that has never been opened—the Gate of Departure. It is emitting a faint yellow light, as if something is waiting inside.

Chapter 5 Completion Record

Sky Street: +1

Heaven: +3

Metropolis: +7

Black Rose: +15

Dragon Region: +4

Cumulative Offset Value: +30 (Threshold)

Chapter 6: Departure Area — Convergence of Extremes

Scene 6-0: [7sref · Threshold Alarm]

(BGM: Continuous Alarm)

Machine: *Alert! Alert! Offset value has risen to 36!*

Sparklink stares at the data.

Sparklink: "What? Why is it still rising?!"

Kurosawa: "The Departure Area is beginning to absorb the offset residue from other regions."

Liz's expression is more serious than ever before.

Liz: "The Departure Area is no ordinary region."

Sparklink: "Then what is it?"

Liz: "It is the starting point of all regions..."

"...and also the end."

The air grows cold again. The light from the Gate of Departure Area grows stronger, changing from pale yellow to golden, then to a piercing white.

Kurosawa: "If we don't go in—"

Liz: "All regions will collapse simultaneously."

Sparklink takes a deep breath.

Sparklink: "Then let's go."

Scene 6-1: [Departure Area · Arrival]

(BGM: Absolute Silence)

Darkness.

Not night. A space without light.

Sparklink turns on the lighting in the cold.

The beam pierces the darkness, illuminating the front. But it's not the ground that's lit—it's fragments. Countless fragments floating in the void like snowflakes, like dust, like torn memories.

The hourglass of Sky Street Area hangs there, still flowing backward.

The purple energy residues of Celestial Area have condensed into blocks, edges flashing with dim light.

The time-loop shadows of the Black Rose Area repeatedly play the same scene—the second Eli disappeared.

The Metropolis Area's structural diagram of the Pandora Prototype is unfurled, its spirals still slowly rotating.

The contract sigil of the Dragon Race floats at the furthest point, like a flag, and like a scar.

Everything is here. Every choice they made, every trace those choices left, is converged here.

Sparklink: (Softly) "Every choice we made... is here."

Kurosawa: "It is converging."

Distant vibrations sound. A low roar.

Scene 6-2: [Pandora Appears]

Space is torn apart.

A spiral mechanical entity crawls out of the rift: its scale is too massive to estimate. Each spiral layer is as large as a city, and each vein is bottomless. It hangs over their heads, rotating slowly, like something that shouldn't exist finally finding a reason to be.

A red core pulses in the deepest part of the spiral—flickering like a heartbeat, like breath, and like a countdown.

Sparklink: "Is this... the End-Time Device?"

Kurosawa: "Not from the future, but from the present."

Liz's voice comes through the comms:

"That is—Pandora."

Sparklink: "But isn't that the future device of the Metropolis?!"

Liz: "Because you unsealed history prematurely."

Kurosawa: "Plus the extreme choices of other regions..."

Liz: "It has been summoned early."

Scene 6-3: [The Truth]

Pandora ends its long silence and begins to release its energy, but as that breath falls on the Departure Area, space begins to dissolve. Those floating fragments disappear one by one, as if they never existed.

Sparklink: (Gritting her teeth) "A monster we built with our own hands."

Kurosawa: "Sky Street Area—Fixed an erroneous world line."

"Celestial Area—Abolished the Demon Realm."

"Black Rose Area—Allowed self-sacrifice."

"Metropolis Area—Prematurely advanced the future."

"Dragon Area—Rewrote the contract."

Sparklink: (Softly) "Not once did we choose to 'keep things as they are'."

Pandora's core flashes. What it wants to tell the two isn't malice, but the established result.

Scene 6-4: [Confrontation]

Kurosawa raises the Magic Flute. Sparklink unfolds her thrusters.

Liz: "Please hold off the core for now!"

An energy torrent presses down like a tsunami. Kurosawa's protection layer is rapidly eroded.

Sparklink: "No, no! I can't take it anymore!"

Kurosawa: "There's no other way! Its energy source is the offset value!"

Sparklink: "Then how do we fight it?"

Kurosawa stands behind Sparklink, holding the Magic Flute, gritting her teeth, propping up a defense layer that's getting thinner and thinner.

Pandora begins to fully unfold. Spirals open layer by layer like a flower blooming, but what blooms isn't petals—it's destruction.

The boundaries of the Departure Area begin to shatter.

The monitoring values of 7sref collapse completely; those numbers jump frantically, finally turning into a mess of garbled code, returning to chaos.

{PLAY: DJ Raisei's Song}

Scene 6-5: [The Decision]

Sparklink suddenly stops her movements.

She looks at Kurosawa.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa."

Kurosawa: "Don't say it."

Sparklink: "You are calmer than I am."

Kurosawa: "We go together."

Sparklink: "And what if both of us are sucked in?"

Kurosawa is stunned. It is the first time—since they met—that such an expression appeared on

Kurosawa's face. Not calm, not restraint, but not knowing what to do.

This is the first time Kurosawa has lost her cool.

Kurosawa: "I won't... I cannot lose anyone else again."

Sparklink chuckles.

Sparklink: "You aren't that person who only knows how to follow orders anymore."

Kurosawa is dazed.

Sparklink continues:

"Let me be the protagonist this time."

Pandora's energy is about to reach its final eruption. Sparklink violently pushes Kurosawa away.

Kurosawa: "Sparklink—!"

Sparklink presses the terminal, activating all computing power, unfolding a massive field.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa, when you save the world and tell the legend to others, remember to praise me more."

The Gate of Departure suddenly lights up again, and the yellow light stabilizes.

Kurosawa is ejected back into the gate by the energy impact, falling unconscious. Tears are clearly flickering in the corner of her eyes.

First second.

Sparklink's field cracks.

Second second.

Computing power begins to collapse.

Third second.

The gate closes completely.

She flies toward the gate, toward the light; she reaches out wanting to grab something, but grabs nothing. She sees Sparklink standing in the distance, within those growing lights, standing in the place that is collapsing.

Sparklink is still smiling.

A smile appears on Sparklink's face once more.

Sparklink: "Finally looked cool for once."

The energy finally swallows her.

7sref. Gray walls. Blue light. Eternal temperature.

But something is missing.

The voice that was always speaking is gone.

Chapter 7: Final Hope — Pandora

Scene 7-1: [7sref · Return]

Kurosawa slowly opened her eyes.

The door dimmed before her, and the last trace of light vanished. That door now looked no different from an ordinary door—gray, cold, never to open again.

Sparklink was not there.

The air was terrifyingly quiet. Not the comfortable kind of quiet, but the kind that says "something is missing." Like a heartbeat skipping a beat and never catching up.

Kurosawa stood up.

Her hands were shaking. She looked down at them, at those still-trembling fingertips. She didn't know why they were shaking. She wasn't cold, she wasn't tired, she just—she just didn't know why they were shaking.

Liz stood in the distance.

She didn't walk over. She just stood there, looking at Kurosawa, saying nothing.

Kurosawa spoke, her voice raspy than she imagined.

Kurosawa: "Where is she?"

Liz: "The Departure Area hasn't completely collapsed yet."

Kurosawa: "Where is she?"

Liz: "..."

Liz did not answer.

Kurosawa turned toward the door.

She didn't cry, but her voice lost its stability for the first time.

Kurosawa: "What is the offset value?"

System Response:

Offset Value: ∞ . Warning: 7sref is being eroded!

Space near the Gate of Departure was violently torn open in a familiar way. The complete form of the Old Pandora began to take shape. Those cracks were like living things, like snakes, like vines, crawling out from the door frame, over the ceiling, the floor, and toward the console. Everywhere the cracks passed, everything began to disassemble, turning into powder, and then the powder vanished too.

Acid's purple umbrella appeared annoyingly once again.

Acid: "My, we've finally reached this point."

Kurosawa looked up. Her gaze was no longer calm, but furious.

Kurosawa: "You knew all along."

Acid smiled.

Acid: "You repaired the gates, but you also pushed them to extremes."

She looked at the collapsing space.

"Now, it's time for the reckoning."

Scene 7-2: [7sref · Brink of Collapse]

(BGM: Low Strings)

The sky of 7sref also turned gray, and space boundaries shattered.

The massive spiral—Old Pandora—hung in the center. Its core pulsed with a mocking red light.

Kurosawa stood at the edge of the rift as Liz struggled to maintain the barrier. The blue light

lines vanished, replaced by the purplish-black seeping from the cracks. Space boundaries were shattering, falling piece by piece into the void, never to be seen again.

Acid walked over slowly, holding her purple umbrella.

Acid: "The Departure Area was originally meant to 'buffer the offset.' I knew you would keep correcting. Because you are Observers."

Liz: (Coldly) "Acid, in this situation, stop testing us!"

Acid giggled.

"I'm helping you, you know."

Scene 7-3: [Truth Revealed]

Acid waved her hand.

The projections of the six gates appeared.

Sky Street Area—Fixed the Fourth World Line.

Celestial Area—Erased the Demon Realm.

Metropolis Area—Advanced history.

Black Rose Area—Allowed self-sacrifice.

Dragon Area—Rewrote the contract.

In each projection of the six gates, a scene was playing.

Sky Street Area—Akatsuki holding Nanoha, the hourglass shattered.

Celestial Area—Momosaki Mika singing, the sky turning blue.

Black Rose Area—Eli's back as she vanishes, Aoul's reaching hand.

Metropolis Area—Newt restarting, technology flowing again.

Dragon Area—The light of the contract rising, dragons landing.

Acid: "Every correction pushed the world toward a single answer."

Kurosawa: "Extremes."

Acid: (Nodding) "The duty of the Departure Area is to balance extremes. But your offset far exceeded the buffer limit."

Liz: (Softly) "Old Pandora is the 'Final Correction' automatically generated by the system."

Kurosawa: "Destroy everything. Reset to zero."

Acid burst into laughter: "Exactly!"

Scene 7-4: [New Pandora]

Acid suddenly unfolded a spell. Those images hadn't vanished; they were still floating, still playing those choices over and over. But as Acid's finger pointed at them, those images began to glow—not with their original light, but with something else.

The six gates began to respond.

Seven-colored energy surged from those images, from those choices, from those corrected worlds. They converged above Acid's head, beginning to condense and take shape.

Liz: (Surprised) "What are you doing?"

Acid: (Smiling) "I am going to create another possibility."

A spiral structure took shape in the air. Smaller than Old Pandora, but more precise. Each spiral layer had a different color, each color from a different region. They were rotating, interweaving, turning into something new.

Acid: "This is... New Pandora."

Kurosawa: "Are you trying to counter extremes with extremes?"

Acid: "No."

She looked back with a seductive smile.

"I want to try countering singularity with diversity."

Scene 7-5: [Kurosawa's Breakdown]

The energy of Old Pandora seemed to double down, becoming heavier, more oppressive, like a mountain collapsing from overhead. Liz's barrier was trembling, those cracks spreading faster, almost impossible to hold.

Kurosawa knelt in the center, helpless; she finally lost her calm.

Kurosawa: "We corrected to save. But we created disaster. Why?! Why is this?!"

Liz: "Do you think you can still bear this responsibility?"

Kurosawa bowed her head.

Kurosawa: "I... I cannot bear it!"

She remembered Sparklink's face. Sparklink's voice.

The sentence Sparklink said before being swallowed by the light.

"When you save the world and tell the legend to others, remember to praise me more."

She looked up.

There was something shining in her eyes, but she held it back. She stood up.

Her knees hurt, but she stood up.

Kurosawa: "But I... I will bear it."

She heavily raised her shotgun.

The shotgun had no wish-charge now...

...only her own will.

{PLAY: ItsMeFisher vs. Psi's song}

Scene 7-6: [The Offensive]

Acid used spells to build an energy path; those colored lights rotated around her, forming a path to the core of Old Pandora, while Liz helped clear the surrounding debris.

Kurosawa held her gun, rushing toward the core of Old Pandora regardless of everything.

The pressure almost crushed her; Old Pandora released an energy burst.

Kurosawa was struck down. She fell from high altitude. The Magic Flute slipped from her hand, the authority of the shotgun began to collapse, those veins dimming inch by inch. Wind howled in her ears, fragments of 7sref flew past, those cracks gaping, waiting to swallow the last shred of hope.

(Is everything really going to end here...)

Chapter 8: Future is Here — 7sRef

Scene 8-1: [Blue Flash]

A blue light pierced the gloom, like the very first blue of the sky, like the nights in the Metropolis not yet covered by neon.

A flight device unfolded.

Someone caught Kurosawa. A familiar voice rang in her ears again.

Sparklink: "Hey, don't just log out on your own."

Kurosawa opened her eyes dizzily, seeing Sparklink's silly smiling face.

Sparklink: "I told you, the protagonist doesn't exit that easily."

Kurosawa's voice trembled with sobs.

Kurosawa: "You..."

Sparklink: "The Departure Area hasn't completely collapsed yet. I followed the data residue of the six gates back. It took a lot of effort!"

She pulled out six Wish Crystals. Each was glowing, but not with a pure, single light. Each had impurities, cracks, and imperfect parts.

Sparklink: "This time, it's not a single wish. It's the 'Unfinished Wishes' of the six regions combined!"

{PLAY: Kou! vs. kanemiko vs. 九立つ気's Song}

Scene 8-2: [The Final Shot]

Kurosawa, accompanied by Sparklink, flew back to the ground.

Stand firm. Raise gun. Aim. Sparklink loaded the crystals into the Gravekeeper Gun. Each was glowing, but with impurities and cracks—imperfection.

Sparklink: "Kurosawa."

Kurosawa: "Mhm."

Sparklink: "Don't hesitate anymore."

Kurosawa smiled.

It was her first true smile.

Kurosawa: "This time, we don't correct."

Sparklink: "We only open possibility."

She aimed at the core of Old Pandora. Pulled the final trigger.

The moment the bullet flew out, it turned into a seven-colored torrent.

Thousands of imperfect wishes interwove at this moment, covering the long night and the endless rain. Thousands of broken glass shards converged here, striking the world's strings together, bursting into the most elevated anthem of life.

The path ahead revealed by the seven gates, the future illuminated by seven-colored light—sketched by every wish in the world.

Those lights entered every layer of the spiral, every vein of the core, every corner of this monster formed by extremes.

Old Pandora's core shattered. The spiral structure disintegrated.

This was a collapse from within: the weight of choice, and the right to choose.

Energy turned into light, into rain, into countless tiny fragments. Those fragments dispersed into the void, mixing with the fragments from previous regions, no longer distinguishable. The seven gates regained their colorful brilliance.

The offset value began to fall; the world gave the responsibility of finding answers to every individual, accepting the imperfect possibility:

$\infty \rightarrow 100 \rightarrow 20 \rightarrow 0$

Scene 8-3: [Restoration]

The sky regained its color, no longer the original blue of 7sref, but another—brighter, warmer, a color more like being alive. Space stopped shattering, those cracks were healing, vanishing as if they had never appeared. Space returned to stability once more.

Acid chuckled.

"Success."

Liz breathed a sigh of relief.

Sparklink sat on the ground laughing:

"Ah hahahahaha... it's good to be alive!"

Kurosawa looked at her.

Kurosawa: "Welcome back."

Sparklink: "Remember to praise me more during the interview."

Kurosawa: "I will."

Scene 8-4: [Epilogue]

The seven gates are operating stably. Fragments of wanderers are returning. Light flows before every gate, each beam leading to a different world. Those worlds haven't become perfect—Sky Street's Fourth World Line remains, the Demon Realm hasn't fully recovered, the history of the Black Rose continues, the Metropolis might still head toward the end, and the dragons and humans still need time.

But the world, it is flowing.

Liz: "Observer, what have you learned?"

Kurosawa looked into the distance.

Kurosawa: "Do not choose answers for the world..."

"...but let the answers exist."

Sparklink: "That sounds like a final boss line."

Kurosawa laughed softly.

The world still flows in its own way, accepting every imperfect possibility.

The screen fades out.

{PLAY: Kanade's Song}